

Sona — Launch Implementation Guide

Document	Sona — Launch Implementation Guide
For	Daniel (founder)
Version	1.0
Date	29 June 2026
Status	Ready to action
Product	Sona — AI front-desk assistant for small UK businesses
Live domain (planned)	asksona.co.uk
Launch tiers	Starter £19 · Pro £39 · Business £79 (per month, 20% off annual)

How to read this guide

This is everything between "the product works on my laptop" and "a stranger can sign up and pay." It is split in two:

- **Part A — Done for you (code).** What has already been built and committed. Nothing to do here; it's context.
- **Part B — Your jobs (founder).** Six setup jobs only you can do, because they need accounts, payment details, or legal wording. Each is a numbered, plain-English walkthrough.

There is no jargon you need to act on. Where a step needs a technical value, it's given to you to copy. Anything marked **[ask Claude]** is something I can do for you once you've supplied the account/keys.

Time to launch: roughly **one focused day** if the domain and accounts go smoothly (a few of the steps have short waits — DNS and email verification — that run in the background).

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Part A — What's already built

All of this is finished, tested, and saved to GitHub. No action needed — it's here so you know what's covered.

Area	What it does
Pricing in £	Whole product shows £; tiers £19 / £39 / £79 with a clear comparison table
Feature locks	In-chat booking and a hidden "Powered by Sona" badge are Pro/Business only; Starter shows the badge (the upgrade nudge). Trials and demos get everything, to feel the value
Booking calendar	Proper month calendar; typing "book Friday at 2pm" jumps to the slot; name now required; late-night hours handled
Demo window	Clean centred preview (~60% of screen), matching fonts, fits on mobile, crisp logo
Onboarding	If a website can't be read, an honest "couldn't read your site" screen (retry / add by hand / continue) instead of a silent broken bot; optional business-name field
Weekly recap + cleanup	Owners automatically get a weekly "what your assistant did" email; old demos auto-delete. <i>(Runs only once the site is live — see Job 1 & 3.)</i>
Branded emails	Lead-alert email and the login email both styled to match the brand
Speed	All pages and the widget are compressed (~75% smaller) for fast loading on customers' sites
Accessibility	The chat is usable with screen readers and keyboard (Escape to close, labelled buttons, larger tap targets)
Privacy tools	"Export / delete a customer's data" controls in Settings (for GDPR requests)

Part B — Your six founder jobs

Do them roughly in this order. Jobs 1–3 get the site live; Job 4 makes it take money; Jobs 5–7 make it trustworthy.

Job 1 — Register the domain (asksona.co.uk)

Why: every link Sona sends (login email, weekly recap, the embed code customers paste) needs a real web address. Right now it points at your laptop.

Step	Do this	Notes
1	Go to your domain registrar (GoDaddy was checked — asksona.co.uk ≈ £12.99/yr)	The .com is taken; .co.uk is the pick
2	Buy asksona.co.uk in your own name	Decline the upsells (privacy add-ons, hosting bundles, email) — not needed
3	Leave the tab open	You'll point it at the host in Job 2

 **Do this yourself** — I can't register domains or enter payment details. It takes ~5 minutes.

Job 2 — Put it online (hosting)

Why: the app currently runs only on your machine. It needs a always-on home on the internet. The project already includes a **Dockerfile** (a recipe that lets any modern host run it), so this is mostly clicking through a host's setup.

Recommended host: Render or Railway — both are beginner-friendly, run Docker out of the box, and cost roughly **\$7–\$10/month** to start. (Fly.io is a cheaper but slightly more technical alternative.)

Step	Do this
1	Create an account at render.com (or railway.app)
2	Choose "New → Web Service" and connect your GitHub, pointing it at the FXLUXE/sona repo
3	When it asks how to build, choose Docker (it will find the Dockerfile automatically)
4	Set the environment values from Job 3 before the first deploy
5	Deploy. You'll get a temporary address like <code>sona.onrender.com</code> — check it loads
6	In the host's "Custom Domain" settings, add asksona.co.uk ; it shows you two DNS records
7	Back in your domain registrar (Job 1), paste those DNS records in. Wait 10–60 min for it to connect

[ask Claude] Once you've created the host account and connected the repo, I can walk you through the exact screens and double-check the settings. I just can't create the account or hold the card.

Job 3 — Set the environment values

Why: these are the secret keys and settings the app needs to talk to its database, AI, email, texts, and payments. You paste them into the host's **"Environment"** tab (Job 2, step 4). They are **secrets** — never put them on GitHub (the app is already set up to keep them off).

You already have most of these in your local `.env` file. The **new** ones for launch are the Stripe block (Job 4) and `GEMINI_PAID` (Job 5). Here's the complete list:

Setting	What it's for	Where it comes from
PUBLIC_BASE_URL	Your live web address	Set to <code>https://asksona.co.uk</code>
SUPABASE_URL	Database address	Supabase project settings
SUPABASE_ANON_KEY	Database public key	Supabase → API settings
SUPABASE_SERVICE_KEY	Database admin key (secret)	Supabase → API settings
GEMINI_API_KEY	The AI that answers	Google AI Studio
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY	Backup/premium AI	Anthropic console (optional if using Gemini paid)
LLM_PROVIDER	Which AI to use	Already set in your <code>.env</code>
GEMINI_PAID	Privacy flag — see Job 5	Set to <code>true</code>
RESEND_API_KEY	Sends emails	resend.com
FROM_EMAIL	The "from" address on emails	e.g. <code>hello@asksona.co.uk</code>
ADMIN_EMAIL	Where admin alerts go	Your email

TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID	Sends SMS lead alerts	twilio.com
TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN	Twilio secret	twilio.com
TWILIO_FROM	Your Twilio phone number	twilio.com
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY	Takes payments — Job 4	Stripe dashboard
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET	Confirms payments — Job 4	Stripe dashboard
STRIPE_PRICE_STARTER	Price ID, Starter monthly	Stripe (Job 4)
STRIPE_PRICE_STARTER_ANNUAL	Price ID, Starter yearly	Stripe (Job 4)
STRIPE_PRICE_PRO	Price ID, Pro monthly	Stripe (Job 4)
STRIPE_PRICE_PRO_ANNUAL	Price ID, Pro yearly	Stripe (Job 4)
STRIPE_PRICE_BUSINESS	Price ID, Business monthly	Stripe (Job 4)
STRIPE_PRICE_BUSINESS_ANNUAL	Price ID, Business yearly	Stripe (Job 4)

The app warns itself at start-up if `PUBLIC_BASE_URL` is missing or still set to localhost — so if you forget this one, you'll see a clear notice in the host's logs.

Job 4 — Turn on payments (Stripe)

Why: right now there are **no payment keys at all**, so the product literally cannot charge anyone. This is the single biggest "can't launch without it" item.

4a. Create the account & products

Step	Do this
1	Sign up at stripe.com , choose United Kingdom , currency GBP (£)
2	Complete business verification (name, bank account for payouts) — Stripe guides you
3	Go to Products → Add product and create three products : Starter, Pro, Business
4	For each product add two prices : a monthly price and a yearly price (yearly = 12 × monthly × 0.8, i.e. 20% off)

The numbers to enter:

Product	Monthly	Yearly (20% off)
Starter	£19.00 / month	£182.40 / year
Pro	£39.00 / month	£374.40 / year
Business	£79.00 / month	£758.40 / year

4b. Copy the keys & price IDs

Each price you create has an ID that looks like `price_1AbCd...` . Copy all six into the matching `STRIPE_PRICE_*` settings from [Job 3](#).

Step	Do this
5	Stripe → Developers → API keys → copy the Secret key → <code>STRIPE_SECRET_KEY</code>
6	Stripe → Developers → Webhooks → Add endpoint . URL = <code>https://asksona.co.uk/api/stripe/webhook</code> . Select events for checkout & subscription updates
7	Copy the webhook's Signing secret → <code>STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET</code>
8	Paste all six price IDs into the six <code>STRIPE_PRICE_*</code> settings

4c. Test it

Step	Do this
9	Use Stripe test mode + a test card (4242 4242 4242 4242) to run one upgrade end-to-end
10	Confirm the account flips to the paid plan, then switch Stripe to live mode and swap in the live keys

[ask Claude] The code side is already wired for these exact key names. Once you've made the products and have the keys, I can help you test the full upgrade flow and confirm the webhook is landing.

Job 5 — Switch the AI to paid mode

Why: on the free AI tier, customer chats **may be used to train the AI provider's models** — not acceptable for a paid product handling business data. The app already warns about this at start-up.

Option	Do this
A (simplest)	In Google AI Studio, enable paid billing on your Gemini key, then set <code>GEMINI_PAID=true</code>
B (alternative)	Provide an <code>ANTHROPIC_API_KEY</code> with billing, which the app uses for paid/regulated tenants

Either one closes the "data may be used for training" warning. **Option A** matches your current setup.

 ~10 minutes in the Google AI Studio billing screen.

Job 6 — Brand the login email

Why: the default sign-in email is a bare, suspicious-looking link — people won't click it. A ready-made, on-brand email has been written for you.

The template file: `docs/email-templates/login-magic-link.html` (in this project). A preview of how it reads:

Subject: *Your Sona login link*

• **Sona Here's your login link** Tap the button below to sign in to your Sona dashboard. No password needed. **[Log in to Sona →]** This link expires in 1 hour and can only be used once...

Step	Do this
1	In Supabase → Authentication → Emails → "Magic Link"

2	Set the Subject to Your Sona login link
3	Open docs/email-templates/login-magic-link.html, copy the whole file, paste it into the Message (HTML) box
4	Leave the {{ .ConfirmationURL }} part exactly as it is — Supabase fills in the real link
5	Send from your own domain: Supabase → Project Settings → Auth → SMTP . Turn on custom SMTP and enter your Resend details so it sends from hello@asksona.co.uk, not a Supabase address
6	Send yourself a test login to check it looks right

[ask Claude] I wrote the email and can tweak the wording/colours any way you like — just say the word. The Supabase/Resend dashboard steps are yours because they need your account login.

Job 7 — Fill in the legal pages

Why: the Terms and Privacy pages exist and cover the UK/GDPR basics, but a few details are marked [REVIEW] and must be real before you sell.

Placeholder	Replace with
Company / trading name	Your business name (and company number if registered)
Contact email	A real address, e.g. privacy@asksona.co.uk
Governing law / jurisdiction	e.g. "the laws of England and Wales"

Step	Do this
1	Decide your trading name, contact email, and jurisdiction
2	[ask Claude] Send me those three details and I'll drop them into the Terms & Privacy pages and commit
3	(Optional but wise) Have a solicitor skim the Terms before launch

The full settings list (reference)

A one-glance copy of every value to set in the host (Job 3). Tick them off as you go.

```
# App
PUBLIC_BASE_URL=https://asksona.co.uk
PORT=3000

# Database (Supabase)
SUPABASE_URL=
SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=
SUPABASE_SERVICE_KEY=

# AI
GEMINI_API_KEY=
GEMINI_PAID=true
```

```

ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=          # optional
LLM_PROVIDER=

# Email (Resend)
RESEND_API_KEY=
FROM_EMAIL=hello@asksona.co.uk
ADMIN_EMAIL=

# SMS (Twilio)
TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID=
TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN=
TWILIO_FROM=

# Payments (Stripe)
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY=
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET=
STRIPE_PRICE_STARTER=
STRIPE_PRICE_STARTER_ANNUAL=
STRIPE_PRICE_PRO=
STRIPE_PRICE_PRO_ANNUAL=
STRIPE_PRICE_BUSINESS=
STRIPE_PRICE_BUSINESS_ANNUAL=

```

Final pre-launch checklist

✓	Item	Job
☐	Domain asksona.co.uk registered	1
☐	App deployed to host, loads on the temporary address	2
☐	Custom domain connected (asksona.co.uk loads the app over https)	2
☐	All environment values set in the host	3
☐	Start-up logs show no config warnings	3
☐	Stripe products + 6 prices created, keys & webhook set	4
☐	One successful test upgrade end-to-end, then switched to live	4
☐	GEMINI_PAID=true (or Anthropic key) — no "training" warning	5
☐	Login email branded + sending from your domain; test received	6
☐	Terms & Privacy placeholders filled	7
☐	Final walk-through: sign up → see demo → install code → upgrade	—

Launch day & the week after

When	What happens
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On launch	A new owner can enter their website, see a live demo built from it, paste one line of code to go live, and upgrade with a card — all self-serve, no calls
Automatically	Each owner gets a weekly "what your assistant did" recap; old demo sites clean themselves up
First week	Watch the host logs for errors; do a real upgrade with your own card to confirm money lands
Next	The post-launch backlog (referral program, the two extra pricing tiers, and the larger feature list) — each gets its own research pass before it's built

*Prepared for Daniel · Sona launch · 29 June 2026. Items marked **[ask Claude]** are ready for me to pick up as soon as you've done the account-side step.*